

Simple Beats Clever

Complexity is not a sign of sophistication, it is usually a liability someone has to babysit forever.

The Clever Disaster

Important emails were slipping through the cracks because no one owned which email. A team member proposed an elaborate system that parsed keywords, auto assigned, and tracked escalation timers. It impressed everyone in the meeting and then failed slowly, misrouting emails and breaking when its one expert went on leave.

The Humble Fix

The simple solution was sitting right there. A shared, monitored inbox with one rule, every email claimed by one named person within an hour, plus a quick daily check. They eventually tore out the clever machine and put it in. It worked immediately and is still working years later.

Why We Overbuild

A big, clever fix feels more valuable and more like real work. But the goal is not to look impressive, it is to make the problem stop with the least cost and risk. AI will happily propose elaborate options too, so keep asking what is the simplest thing that would actually fix the root cause.

Remember this

Recommending the humble checklist over the dazzling automation shows more maturity than chasing the shiny build.